

The paradox

The tools developers use to build (accessible) software... are often **not accessible themselves**.

A lot of knowledge is locked in **black boxes** behind **paid tools** and with **subscriptions**.

Open source can help here.

Tim Damen

- 👤 Front-end developer & accessibility advocate
- 🇳🇱 Working as an engineer in the Netherlands
- 🔗 Passionate about making the web work for **everyone**
- 🧩 Contributor to  **Nuxt**, **@nuxt/a11y**, and more
- 🔧 Building **WCAGify** — open source accessibility tooling



Why open source matters

For the web, for society, and for you



The Linux Foundation

LINES OF CODE

1.5 M
IN TH



Bekijken op  YouTube

The web was built on open source

The internet as we know it wouldn't exist without open source.

Every website you visit, every app you build — it runs on a foundation of open source software that people shared freely with the world.

Let's look at two people who changed everything.

Linus Torvalds — 🐧 Linux & 🔌 Git

- **1991** — Created 🐧 **Linux** as a university student in Helsinki
 - Today it powers **96.3%** of the world's top servers
 - Every Android phone. Most of the cloud. The ISS.
- **2005** — Created 🔌 **Git** out of frustration
 - Built it to manage Linux kernel development
 - Now the backbone of how **100M+ developers** collaborate
- One person shared their work. **The world built on it.**



Where 🐧 Linux &  Git were built



Evan You — Vue, Vite & the modern frontend

- **2014** — Created  **Vue.js** as a solo side project
 - "I wanted to extract the parts I liked about  Angular and build something lightweight"
 - Today: **4M+ weekly**  **npm downloads**, used by companies worldwide
- **2020** — Created  **Vite** to rethink build tooling
 - Replaced  Webpack's slow bundling with native ES modules
 - Now powers  **Vue**,  **Nuxt**,  **Svelte**,  **Astro**,  **SolidStart**, and more
- **2026** — Released  **Vite 8** and launched **Vite Plus**
 - The ecosystem keeps growing, year after year
- One developer's side project became an **entire ecosystem**



The ecosystem they enabled

Layer	Open Source Projects
Runtime	 Linux,  Node.js,  Deno,  Bun
Frameworks	 React,  Vue,  Angular,  Svelte,  Solid
Meta-frameworks	 Next.js,  Nuxt,  Astro,  SvelteKit
Build tools	 Vite,  esbuild,  Turbopack,  Rollup
Version control	 Git,  GitHub,  GitLab
Infrastructure	 Docker,  Kubernetes,  Terraform

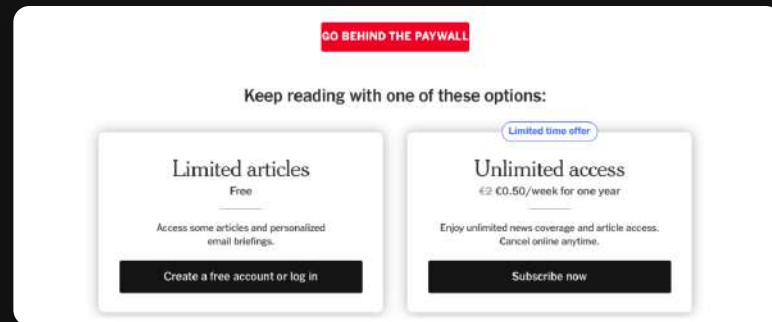
Your job as a web developer today exists because people chose to share their work openly.

No paywalls, no gatekeeping

The best innovations happened because tools were **freely available**.

Open source tools mean:

- No data collection
- No sign up required
- Free to use
- Open source — anyone can inspect, improve, contribute



Why this matters

Good open source tooling has enabled **massive innovation**. If we keep building and sharing freely, it will continue to do so — for everyone.

GitHub quiz time

Let's see how well you know the platform where open source lives

3 questions. Shout out your guesses.

Which real project has the most commits on GitHub? 🏆

🐧 **torvalds/linux** — ~1.4 million commits

- Started in 1991, still going strong with ~75,000-80,000 commits/year
- Crossed 1 million commits in August 2020
- The runner-up? 🍺 Homebrew — with only ~120,000

Fun fact: the actual record is **RVFET/committed** with 100,889,089 commits — all empty, generated by a bot at 90,000/min to test GitHub's limits. It got archived.

What is the most-starred repo on GitHub?

codecrafters-io/build-your-own-x — ~484,000 stars 🌟

Not a framework. Not a tool. **A Markdown file** with links to tutorials for rebuilding technologies from scratch.

4 out of 5 most-starred repos are curated lists, not software.

Repo	Stars	What it is
build-your-own-x	~484K	Tutorial aggregator
awesome	~450K	Curated topic lists
freeCodeCamp	~439K	Coding curriculum

What is the fastest-growing repo in GitHub history?

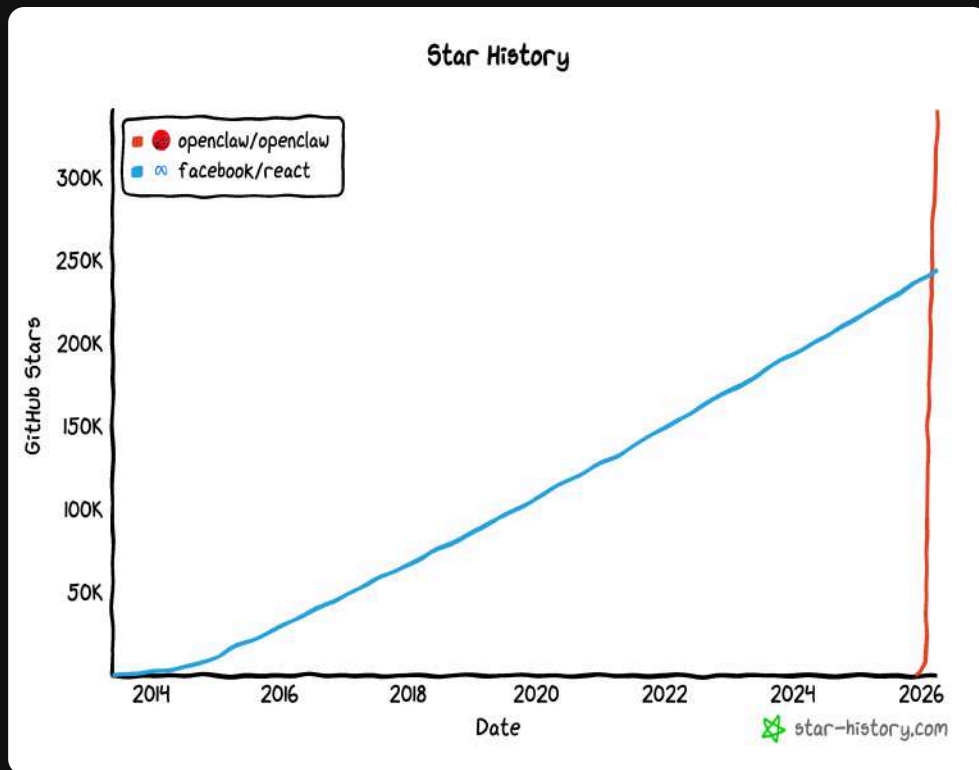
OpenClaw — ~340,000 stars in under 5 months

An open-source AI agent that went from 9,000 to 100,000 stars in **days**. For comparison,  React took **over a decade** to reach 250,000 stars.

Metric	 OpenClaw	 React
Time to 100K stars	~3 months	~7 years
Time to 250K stars	~60 days	~10 years
Peak growth	Tens of thousands/day	Gradual



OpenClaw vs React — star history



Open source: 4 reasons it matters for YOU



Transparency as quality assurance

Everyone can inspect, review, and improve the code. Audits in public, not behind a paywall.



Learning in public

A PR history is a growth path more visible than any certificate. Learn from reviewers worldwide.



People you'd never otherwise meet

The OSS community transcends companies, countries, and seniority. You build a network by *doing*.



OSS as a living portfolio

More concrete than a CV line. Recruiters can see your contributions and immediately assess your value.

A journey into open source

The beginning

The first contribution

- A typo fix? An issue? A PR?
- Let's take a step back

Learn about the project

- Use it, test it, intergrate it, understand it
- Read the contribution descriptions
- Try to connect with the community
- Make a meaningfull improvement

The vulnerability

- Writing code in public is **vulnerable**
- Learning to deal with rejection and turn it into growth

Good to know



Volkan Yazıcı

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Log4j maintainers have been working sleeplessly on mitigation measures; fixes, docs, CVE, replies to inquiries, etc. Yet nothing is stopping people to bash us, for work we aren't paid for, for a feature we all dislike yet needed to keep due to backward compatibility concerns.

5:55 PM · Dec 10, 2021



8.7K



Reply



Copy link

[Read 163 replies](#)



@nuxt/a11y

Accessibility utils for the Nuxt ecosystem

How it started

Talked to Daniel Roe at Viteconf

- Spoke about Open Source and where to start
- Talked about my background and interests

What was missing in Nuxt?

-  Nuxt is the most popular  Vue meta-frameworks
- Nuxt has a nice way to intergrate modules in to the Nuxt Devtools
- But a core **accessibility module** was missing





@nuxt/a11y — The solution

What it does

- Automated accessibility checks during development
- Runtime warnings for common a11y violations
- Guidance on learning about and start fixing issues — not just flagging them

Future

- More intergration with the Nuxt ecosystem
- Add more a11y utility features

Demo: @nuxt/a11y

500+

Projects **5** completed

50+

Team **6** members

10+

Years **7** experience

95%

Client **8** satisfaction

Our Journey

2020	Company Founded
2021	First Major Client
2023	Expanded to 50+ Team Members
2025	Launched A11y Testing Tool

12 elements

21 elements

4 elements

0 elements

CRITICAL ISSUES 1 (5 ELEMENTS)

CRITICAL

image-alt

/about-us

Images must have alternative text

Ensure elements have alternative text or a role of none or presentation

[Learn about the image-alt rule](#)

> Affected Elements (5)

SERIOUS ISSUES 4 (12 ELEMENTS)

SERIOUS

color-contrast

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

/about-us

Elements must meet minimum color contrast ratio thresholds

Ensure the contrast between foreground and background colors meets WCAG 2 AA minimum contrast ratio thresholds



GitHub

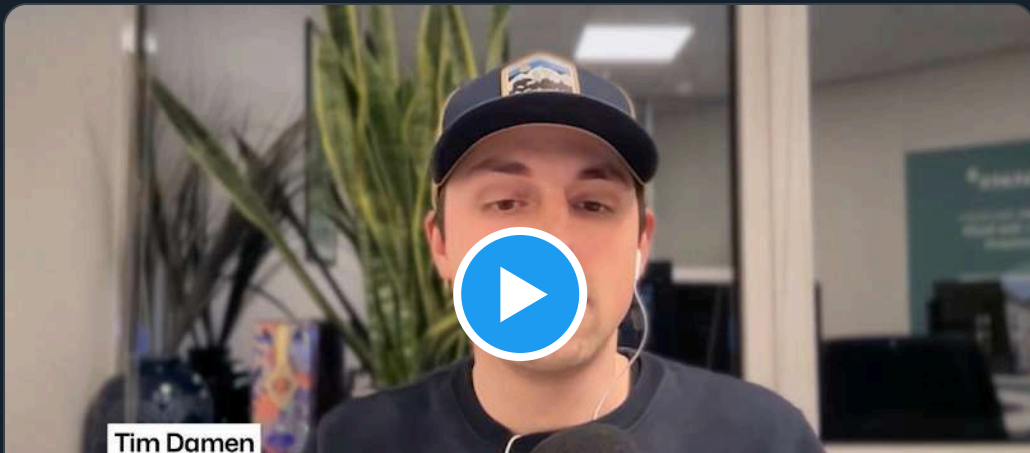
@github · [Follow](#)



Real-time accessibility checks directly in Nuxt DevTools are now a reality.

Check out the Nuxt A11y module. It's built on axe-core and scans your app as you navigate, highlighting WCAG issues directly on the page with zero production impact.

By helping teams catch issues early, [Show more](#)



The OSS side of @nuxt/a11y

Working with Nuxt core maintainers

- Collaborating with **Daniel Roe** and the Nuxt team
- The review process — what did you learn?
- The difference between writing code alone vs. code a community will use

Key takeaway

Contributing to a well-maintained OSS project teaches a lot about software engineering

Demo 2: WCAGify

Behind the scenes of something new

WCAGify — The story

"This is something I'm building right now. You're seeing it before it's finished — and that's exactly how open source works."

The problem it solves

- What gap does WCAGify fill?
- What tools already exist, and why aren't they enough?
- Who is this for?

The approach

- Architecture decisions and trade-offs
- How you think when building *for* accessibility

Live demo: WCAGify

The screenshot shows the WCAGify web application interface. At the top, there's a header with the WCAGify logo on the left and a 'settings' link on the right. Below the header, the 'Results' section displays four colored boxes: a green box for 'Passed' (0), a red box for 'Failed' (2), a blue box for 'Not present' (0), and a yellow box for 'Not tested' (48). The 'Failed' box is highlighted with a dashed border. Below the results, the 'Operable' section is shown, with a sub-section for '2.1: Keyboard Accessible'. Under this, there's a list of failed items: '2.1.1: Keyboard' (Failed) and '1. Not all functionality is reachable with the keyboard' (Failed), with a 'Contact page' link. Below this, the '2.4: Navigable' section is shown, with a list of failed items: '2.4.7: Focus Visible' (Failed) and '1. Focus style missing on interactive elements' (Failed), with a 'Homepage' link. The interface is dark-themed with a blue background.

WCAGify

settings

Results

✓ 0 Passed	✗ 2 Failed	✗ 0 Not present	✗ 48 Not tested
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Operable

User interface components and navigation must be operable.

2.1: Keyboard Accessible

A 2.1.1: Keyboard ✗ Failed

1. Not all functionality is reachable with the keyboard Contact page ✗ Failed

2.4: Navigable

AA 2.4.7: Focus Visible ✗ Failed

1. Focus style missing on interactive elements Homepage ✗ Failed

Building together

WCAGify isn't finished — and that's the point.

Open source means you don't have to build alone.

If this resonates with you — if you want to help make accessibility tooling free and open...

Let's build this together.

Build together, accessed by all

Open source and accessibility share the same philosophy:

Nobody builds this alone, and it's not done until it **works for everyone**.

You are developers. You can change this — not with a grand heroic act, but with **one PR, one issue, one tool you share**.

Thank You

Let's build together.

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 LinkedIn **Tim Damen**

 @nuxt/a11y **github.com/nuxt/a11y**

WCAGify **Coming soon**